

How can agency, provider, policy, organization or initiative deliverables be aligned with outcomes ('Line-of-Sight Alignment')?

In traditional planning, various techniques are used to try to check for alignment between outcomes and lower-level strategies, activities or projects. Higher-level outcomes (vision statements, targets, goals, etc.) are listed. What's going to be done (strategies, projects, deliverables or activities, etc.) are then listed, and the attempt is made to somehow demonstrate the relationship between these two. This is typically done in ways such as: text-based descriptions accompanying each outcome describing which strategies, activities or projects it is believed will influence it; text-based descriptions with each strategy, activity or project detailing the outcome(s) it's focused on influencing; numbering the outcomes and putting these numbers next to the strategies, activities or projects being focused on; or, lastly, using a table format to communicate the above. In contrast, in DoView Planning you check for alignment by visually mapping strategy, activity or project boxes onto the relevant higher-level boxes (steps/outcomes) it is believed they will influence within a strategy/outcomes diagram.

If this mapping is done in apps or platforms with appropriate features*, it can provide a count of the number of strategies, activities or projects that are mapped onto each higher-level step/outcome box, and by interacting with the boxes in the app, you can list the names of the relevant activities or projects. If the app lets you proportionately 'weigh' how much each strategy/activity/project is believed will influence each step/outcome, you can get an even better picture of alignment - how much effort is being focused on each step/outcome. Such visual mapping quickly shows whether or not you actually have 'Line-of-Sight' alignment. AI enhanced versions of this built into apps and platforms will make the process of mapping easier and provide even more insights into 'line of sight' alignment.

In the example in this DoView Visual Alignment Tool (C3), you can see that the box 'Arrows sharp enough', despite being an 'A' priority, does not have any lower-level project boxes mapping onto it. The absence of any of these shows a lack of 'line-of-sight' alignment between the agency's outcomes and its activities or projects.

* For instance the DoView legacy app